Globalization and culture

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: Globalization and culture: one world or many? (196 words)

Globalization has linked economies and societies as never before. A **multinational** company can design a product in one country, assemble it in another and sell it in a third. **Outsourcing** moves jobs abroad, while a **trade barrier** raised by one government can **send shockwaves through** the whole system. Countries that **export** machinery grow rich; those that **import** most of their food are vulnerable to price shocks.

Culture is changing too. **Tourism** brings welcome income, but **mass tourism** can damage local **tradition** and fragile landscapes. Critics fear that global brands are making the world more **homogenous**, with the same shops and the same songs everywhere. A nation's **heritage**, its language and its **cultural identity** may seem to be fading, and a **native language** without speakers can disappear in a generation. Strong **influence** from powerful cultures also risks spreading **stereotype** images of other peoples.

Yet contact can also enrich. **Diversity** makes workplaces and cities more creative, and **cross-cultural** understanding has become a key skill. When people move, they must **adapt**, and many **assimilate** into a new society while keeping their own **customs**. The challenge is to **reap the benefits of** an open world without losing what makes each place distinctive.

Useful phrases from the article

PHRASE	MEANING
send shockwaves through	strongly affect
reap the benefits of	gain from

The 20 new words

WORD		MEANING	EXAMPLE
globalization	n	the growing connection of world economies and cultures	*Globalization has made products cheaper.*
cultural identity	n	the sense of belonging to a culture	*Language is part of cultural identity.*
multinational	adj	operating in many countries	*Multinational companies employ millions.*
tradition	n	a custom passed from generation to generation	*Many traditions are disappearing.*
heritage	n	history and culture inherited from the past	*Old buildings are part of our heritage.*
customs	n	the usual ways of behaving in a society	*Customs differ from country to country.*

assimilate	v	to become part of a new culture	*Immigrants often assimilate within a generation.*
stereotype	n	a fixed and often unfair idea about a group	*Films can spread stereotypes.*
tourism	n	the business of travel for pleasure	*Tourism brings money to small towns.*
mass tourism	n	large numbers of tourists	*Mass tourism damages fragile places.*
export	v	to sell goods to other countries	*The country exports electronics.*
import	v	to bring goods in from other countries	*We import most of our oil.*
trade barrier	n	a rule that limits trade	*Trade barriers raise prices.*
outsourcing	n	giving work to another country or company	*Outsourcing moved jobs abroad.*
homogenous	adj	all the same	*Fast food is making cultures more homogenous.*
diversity	n	variety of people and ideas	*Diversity makes workplaces more creative.*
native language	n	the first language you learn	*Protect your native language.*
cross-cultural	adj	involving different cultures	*Cross-cultural understanding is a key skill.*
influence	n	the power to change something	*Western films have a strong influence.*
adapt	v	to change to suit new conditions	*Immigrants must adapt to a new society.*

Revision: 10 words from last week

WORD		MEANING
mass media	n	TV, newspapers and the internet together
advertisement	n	a public message selling a product
consumer	n	a person who buys goods
brand	n	a product name with a certain image
influencer	n	a person with many followers who affects buying
celebrity	n	a famous person
endorse	v	to publicly support a product
censorship	n	control of what the public can see
bias	n	an unfair preference for one side
headline	n	the title of a news story

Practice: fill the gaps

homogenous · customs · export · adapt · globalization · heritage · outsourcing · multinational

1. Fast food is making cultures more _____.
2. _____ differ from country to country.
3. The country _____ electronics.
4. Immigrants must _____ to a new society.
5. _____ has made products cheaper.
6. Old buildings are part of our _____.
7. _____ moved jobs abroad.
8. _____ companies employ millions.

More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

ancestry (n): the people you are descended from
ceremony (n): a formal event for a special purpose
colonial (adj): connected with colonies
cosmopolitan (adj): including people from many countries
cultural exchange (n): sharing culture between countries
custom (n): a traditional habit
dialect (n): a regional form of a language
embrace (v): to accept eagerly
ethnic (adj): connected with a cultural group
expatriate (n): a person living abroad
festival (n): a celebration with special events
folklore (n): traditional stories and beliefs
foreign investment (n): money invested from abroad
global village (n): the world seen as one community
heritage site (n): a place of historic importance
host country (n): the country where a visitor stays
immigration (n): moving to another country
integration (n): becoming part of a society
interconnected (adj): joined with each other
language barrier (n): difficulty communicating in another language
local (adj): from a particular place
migrant (n): a person who moves to find work
minority (n): a smaller group in a society
multicultural (adj): including many cultures
mutual (adj): shared by two groups
nationality (n): belonging to a nation
open-minded (adj): willing to accept new ideas
preserve (v): to keep safe
refugee (n): a person who has fled from danger
westernization (n): adopting Western culture

Topic kit: what to know about this topic

Writing Task 2 questions you may meet

1. Some people think globalization is making all cultures the same. To what extent do you agree or disagree?
2. More people are travelling abroad for tourism. What are the advantages and disadvantages for local communities?
3. Immigrants should adopt the customs of the country they move to. To what extent do you agree?
4. Traditional languages are disappearing. What are the causes and what can be done?

Ideas you can use in essays and in speaking

- **For / good:** Global trade lowers prices and offers more choice.
- **Against / bad:** Local shops and traditions disappear when global brands dominate.
- **For / good:** Tourism creates jobs and money for small towns.
- **Against / bad:** Mass tourism damages nature and raises living costs for residents.
- **For / good:** Contact between cultures brings new ideas, food and music.
- **Against / bad:** Small languages vanish when children learn only a global language.

Speaking

Part 1

- Do you like travelling?
- What traditions does your family keep?
- Have you ever lived abroad?
- Do you like foreign food?
- What do visitors like most about your country?

Part 3

- Is it important to keep traditions?
- What are the effects of tourism on local people?
- Are cultures becoming the same?
- Should immigrants learn the local language?

Part 2 cue card. Describe a tradition in your country that you like. You should say: what it is, when it happens, what people do, and explain why you like it.

Answers

1. homogenous (homogenous)
2. Customs (customs)
3. exports (export)
4. adapt (adapt)
5. Globalization (globalization)
6. heritage (heritage)
7. Outsourcing (outsourcing)
8. Multinational (multinational)